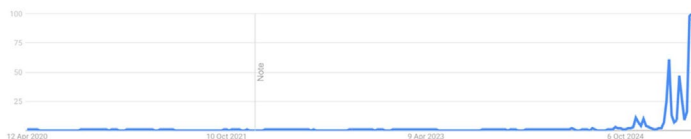


12 years after the hype, we finally have a 3D printing stock worth buying

The airwaves and newsfeeds are buzzing with tariffs, tariffs, tariffs.

Look at the Google searches for “tariffs” spiking to record highs below. If that were a stock, I’d buy it.



Source: Google Trends

We *do* need to make more stuff in America. We learned that lesson during COVID.

Remember the panic when doctors in NYC, the world’s richest city, were told to wear *ponchos* as protective equipment?

There’s also the innovation angle. When the factory floor is down the hall instead of 30 hours away, rapid iteration is far easier.

One thing I learned on a recent trip through California’s tech and manufacturing hubs was that America outsourced *making* things, and in the process, outsourced the *knowing how* to make things.

We chased high-margin design and let the “dirty work” drift overseas.

But wealth isn’t just fancy logos or lines of code. It’s the power to shape the physical world. That takes two things: know-how *and* the machines to do it.

You can separate them for a while, but not forever. Lose the machines, and eventually, the know-how fades too.

In this month’s issue

We must double down on America’s strength

Meet America’s industrial alchemists

Innovation = salvation

Building the future, layer by layer

NNDM’s path to profits

America’s fastest-growing stocks

Then there's the human element. We've pushed this idea that everyone needs a four-year degree for an office job. The laptop class manipulating words and numbers thrived. But what about folks who excel at building and designing stuff with their bare hands?

Without a vibrant manufacturing sector offering well-paid jobs, where does that talent go?

Yes, I am in favor of "Made in the USA."

No, tariffs aren't the magic wand to bring manufacturing jobs back to America.

We must double down on America's strength...

Innovation.

If we want American manufacturing to truly roar back, we must stop looking backward and start leaping forward.

The *only* long-term path is to win by *out-innovating* everyone else. It means doubling down on our greatest strength: relentless technological innovation.

Forget recreating the factories of the 1950s. Those jobs are gone and they ain't coming back.

We need to build the factories of the future. We need to embrace technologies like robotics, artificial intelligence (AI), and 3D printing (this month's pick). They're the core engines of America's new industrial revolution.

I saw this future whirring away in El Segundo recently. A sleek 3D printer—moving like a robotic pen in mid-air—was precisely building complex parts for drones, layer by tiny layer.

Nathan Mintz, the founder of CX2—which is creating electronic warfare systems—told me, "These things work night and day in the background."

Machines turning digital ideas into physical stuff. That's how America wins.

Meet America's industrial alchemists

Drown out the tariff noise, and you'll find companies bringing this high-tech future to life.

LA-based space startup [Relativity Space](#) is 3D printing *entire rockets*, drastically cutting parts count and build time.

A few miles down the road, [Hadrian](#) is building automated factories to churn out high-precision aerospace and defense components 10X faster and 50% cheaper than before.

Why is Elon Musk the only person to have successfully scaled manufacturing in America over the past decade? To quote Elon, “The factory is the product.”

Tesla (TSLA) doesn’t just make electric cars. It’s reinventing how cars are made.

Tesla’s Gigafactories are 95% automated. Assembly starts with three different body parts getting robotically stamped into shape. Then, more than 600 robots weld those parts together with micron-level precision.

Finally, the frame is hoisted into the paint shop by “Godzilla,” one of the biggest robotic arms in the world:



Tesla's Giga Press | Source: Danilo Onorino on LinkedIn

Would you live in a 3D-printed house? As you read this, a startup called ICON is putting the finishing touches on the world’s largest 3D-printed neighborhood outside Austin, Texas.

The homes are built by a giant robot weighing nearly 5 tons. It looks like a huge pastry bag. It carefully squeezes out layers of concrete to construct the walls of what will become a home. The foundations and roofs are still built the old-school way. But the walls—one of the most time-consuming parts—rise from the ground in days rather than weeks.

We’re even “printing” nuclear parts!

Virginia-based BWXT Advanced Technologies uses 3D printers to craft nuclear reactor components with complex twists that are impossible to make traditionally. Raw American steel.



Sources: Oak Ridge National Laboratory; 3Dnatives

Innovation = salvation

A tech-enabled industrial base is the salvation of American manufacturing.

It's not about bringing back old jobs. It's about creating *new*, better ones for people who design for 3D printing, manage robotic systems, write the software, and develop new materials.

It's about building powerful machines that let us invent almost anything and then bring it to life.

For the past 40 years, shipping manufacturing overseas was a substitute for the hard work of manufacturing innovation. Finding cheap labor was easier than innovating how we make things in America. Now, that era is ending.

The exciting part is we're now being *forced* to get good at building physical things again, using incredible new tools.

Tariffs *accelerate* the shift toward tech-driven manufacturing. Why wait months for a part from overseas and rack your brain navigating tariffs when you can print it at home in hours?

You've seen the rusted mega-factories, relics of a past industrial age. Imagine replacing them with sleek, automated facilities. Maybe even "dark factories" operating with minimal human intervention.

Picture a factory with a handful of humans babysitting thousands of robots. Now, picture those factories popping up everywhere. We could produce 1,000X more stuff for a fraction of today's cost. When THAT happens (it's already started), it could create trillions of dollars in wealth.

AI-powered robots transform "Made in America" from teary-eyed nostalgia into a symbol of cutting-edge innovation. The future, not the past.

This is how America and the West win. Let's build things that matter, build them better than anyone else, and build them right here.

I'll hand you off to Chris to tell you about a little-known disruptor reinventing how we build, one layer at a time.

Building the future, layer by layer

As Stephen implied in his enthralling lead, we're targeting a 3D printing company this month.

This issue of *Disruption_X* is more than 12 years in the making. I (Chris Wood) have been searching for a company like this since I recommended selling out of 3D printing stocks in a previous advisory at the end of 2012.

Unfortunately, the 3D printing space has been "uninvestable" for over a decade.

That's now changed.

What's more, the stock I'm going to tell you about today reflects my favorite (but very rare) setup for a growth stock...

It's an off-the-radar company with great tech, operating in an unloved megatrend. And it's transforming itself with smart acquisitions and leadership changes for explosive near-term growth... but no one's paying attention to it yet.

What's particularly interesting is that this company didn't become a great investment opportunity until just a few weeks ago.

Here's the story:

You may remember all the hype around 3D printing back in 2010 and 2011. "3D printing" was the hottest buzzword on the planet, plastered across major magazines and newspapers...

- **"3-D Printing Spurs a Manufacturing Revolution"** —*The New York Times* (September 13, 2010)
- **"The Next Trillion Dollar Industry: 3D Printing"** —*Business Insider* (February 28, 2011)
- **"3D Printing: The Technology that Could Re-Shape the World"** —*The Telegraph* (July 28, 2011)

Investors, including me, piled in... and 3D printing stocks shot off like a rocket.

I recommended the two poster children of the 3D printing boom—**3D Systems (DDD)** and **Stratasys (SSYS)**—in a previous advisory back in July and August of 2011, respectively.

3D Systems jumped about 2,400% between January 2010 and January 2014. Stratasys soared about 750% during the same period.

I wasn't as seasoned an investor back then. So while we did book big gains on those stocks, I left a lot on the table when I recommended selling both near the end of 2012.

But it was a good thing we didn't hold on too long. Both stocks collapsed in 2014. By the end of 2015, they had given up nearly all their gains from the run. And they've fallen further since.

Today, Stratasys and 3D Systems are trading about 50% below where they were in early January 2010.

Aside from a brief bump during the COVID craziness, 3D printing stocks have been dead money ever since.

It's not that 3D printing went away. It's just that it failed to meet the early hype. This is what happens to virtually all exciting emerging technologies... There's a boom. Then there's a bust.

It happened with British railroads in the 1840s... internet stocks at the turn of this century... and cryptos in the early 2010s.

Gartner tech consultants Jackie Fenn and Mark Raskino describe the phenomenon in their book from the mid-1990s called "Mastering the Hype Cycle."

3D printing is simply the process of joining materials together to make three-dimensional objects. The "printer" starts with three-dimensional CAD (computer-aided design) data, cuts the model into thin layers with "slicer software," and creates the desired object layer by layer.

In other words, 3D printing is additive. Traditional manufacturing is subtractive and usually involves cutting material away from a larger piece.

Here's something I wrote about the phenomenon as it applied to 3D printing back in 2015:

To see the hype cycle in action today, look no further than the 3D printing industry.

The story of the 3D printing industry is the same story we see over and over and over again when it comes to new technologies and the stocks that represent them.

A promising tech comes along that grabs peoples' attention. The media joins the parade with great fanfare and expectations. Soon, everyone knows it's going to be the next big thing. The hype pushes the stocks in the space higher and higher. Fundamentals go out the window. Valuations reach nosebleed levels.

Then, when this new tech fails to change the world right away, people start to bail. The media's sentiment changes. They question whether the new tech can actually deliver on its promise. The questions morph into negative statements. They use the word "bubble" often. Investors flee in droves, and the stocks tank.

But if there's real long-term value in the technology, the best investments in the space not only come back *but thrive*.

We know there's real value in 3D printing because of its real-world benefits over traditional manufacturing processes, which continue to drive rapid growth.

Some of those benefits include:

- **Rapid deployment:** Since 3D printing eliminates the need for tooling and setup, manufacturing can begin immediately after a design is complete. What used to take days, weeks, or months can now be measured in minutes and hours.
- **Low setup costs:** Traditional dies and tools are expensive. By cutting out those expenses, 3D printing allows for a much lower initial cash outlay to begin manufacturing.
- **Less waste:** While traditional “subtractive” manufacturing processes can often remove up to 90% of the raw material to arrive at a finished component, 3D printers only use the material they need to make the part.
- **Design flexibility:** Traditional manufacturing methods are bound by rules—such as design for manufacturability (DFM) and design for assembly (DFA)—that govern the complexity, and ultimately the performance, of products. Since 3D printing constructs parts with an additive fabrication process, complex designs are just as easy to manufacture as simple ones.

In fact, 3D printers can create structures that are more intricate than any other manufacturing technique and that are impossible to build any other way. You can create parts with moving components, hinges, and parts within parts. Changes cost almost nothing to make. So, 3D printing promotes product innovation and allows design to be highly optimized for performance.

Over the past five years, the 3D printing market has grown 20%+ annually, reaching about \$25 billion last year. Industry analysts say this market could more than triple over the next five years, potentially reaching \$100 billion by 2030.

Meanwhile, a small Israeli company called **Nano Dimension Ltd. (NNDM)** could be the best investment opportunity in the 3D printing space in over a decade.

A 3D printing empire

Nano Dimension is best known for its patented additively manufactured electronics (AME) technology.

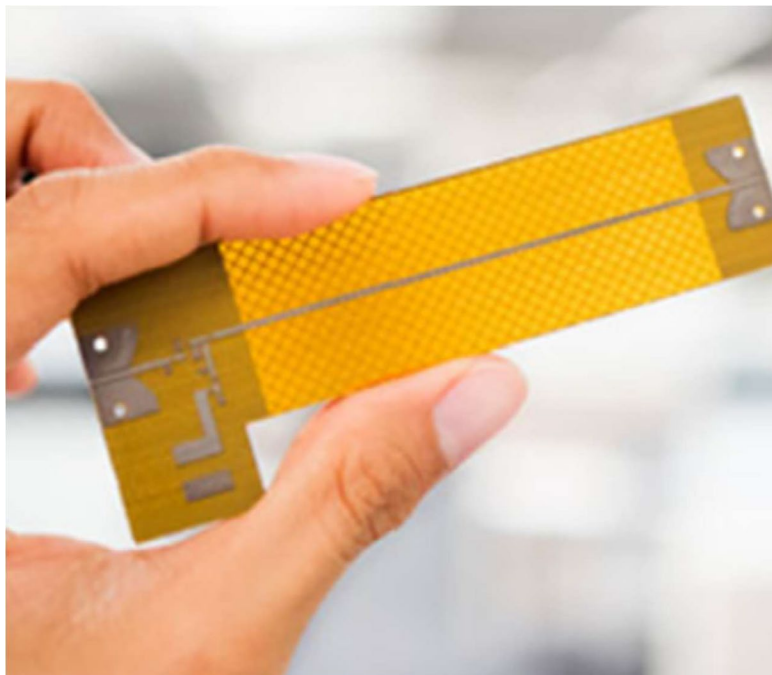
Additive manufacturing (AM) is another name for 3D printing. Nano Dimension’s AME systems can 3D-print fully functional high-performance electronic devices—like 5G antennas, vertically stacked integrated circuits, and access points for WiFi and Internet of Things devices—and complex printed circuit boards.

The company’s DragonFly IV printer, for example, is a one-stop fabrication system for AME that allows customers to build, test, and iterate electronics designs in a single day.

In other words, it's a completely new way to build electronics. It can do this because of the technology Nano Dimension developed to print with multiple proprietary materials at the same time.

Nano Dimension has been doing this for years. Its DragonFly system made the first 3D-printed RF amplifier that launched into space back in 2021, for example.

This is what it looked like:



Source: Nano Dimension

Nano Dimension's systems have also been used to advance neuroscience research by 3D printing intricate devices that can record brain activity in live mice.

The medical field is using them to print lab-on-a-chip devices for diagnostics, wearable health monitors, and implantable sensors. The defense industry is using them to make electronics for drones, satellites, and advanced communication systems. And NASA is using them to help develop sustainable energy storage solutions for space exploration.

Part of what makes Nano Dimension's 3D printing systems special is its AI platform technology, which the company acquired in April 2021 when it bought a company called DeepCube.

The AI platform is integrated into Nano Dimension's systems to improve all sorts of key manufacturing metrics like quality, consistency, yield, productivity, and uptime. It also enables real-time quality control and self-correcting printing, which keeps costs down.

DeepCube was one of seven companies Nano Dimension acquired from about mid-2021 to mid-2023. Before it started the acquisition spree, Nano Dimension was a niche 3D printing player with one additive manufacturing technology for one application—electronics.

The company has a lot more going on today. And its two most recent acquisitions—the eighth and ninth since mid-2021—are truly transformative.

On April 2, Nano Dimension announced it had completed the acquisition of a 3D printing powerhouse called **Desktop Metal (DM)** for about \$180 million.

Desktop Metal invented two next-generation 3D printing technologies. One of these technologies is super-fast and scalable, allowing for the mass production of metal components like engine parts, tooling inserts, and heat exchangers.

The other technology is widely used for its precision and ability to print extremely fine details for things like medical devices and intricate jewelry.

The Desktop Metal acquisition also brings Nano Dimension about \$150 million in additional annual revenue, over a thousand patents, and thousands of customers.

Nano Dimension is also close to completing the acquisition of 3D printing company **Markforged Holding (MKFG)** for about \$115 million.

Markforged's innovative platform, The Digital Forge, combines 3D printers, proprietary metal and composite materials, and cloud-based software to bring industrial production to the point of need on the factory floor.

The Markforged acquisition also brings Nano Dimension more than \$85 million in additional annual revenue, thousands of customers around the world, and about 150 issued US and foreign patents.

Both Desktop Metal and Markforged were multibillion-dollar companies a few years ago. But Nano Dimension was able to acquire them for a combined total of about \$300 million.

See, Nano Dimension raised over a billion dollars back in 2020 and early 2021. It used a chunk of that money to buy the seven companies I mentioned earlier, including DeepCube. But it kept a lot of cash in its coffers and waited for valuations in the 3D printing space to come down.

These companies tend to burn through a lot of cash, and most (except Nano Dimension) are running out of money today. And their current valuations reflect that.

So, Nano Dimension was able to buy Desktop Metal and Markforged for around 1X trailing 12-month revenue. Back in 2021, Desktop Metal traded above 35X trailing 12-month revenue, and Markforged traded as high as around 20X.

Meanwhile, here's a snapshot of the company today, including the completed Desktop Metal acquisition and the soon-to-be-completed Markforged acquisition:

A Snapshot of Today

...We Have Now Built, Developed and Acquired a Full Suite of Digital Manufacturing Solutions



Source: Nano Dimension

Nano Dimension's path to profits

Today, Nano Dimension is a leader in 3D printing, providing a one-stop shop with the best additive manufacturing technologies.

The company offers all sorts of materials for every possible application. Thousands of customers throughout the world rely on its solutions, including **Amazon (AMZN)**, **Disney (DIS)**, **Alphabet (GOOGL)**, **Microsoft (MSFT)**, **Toyota (TM)**, **Lockheed Martin (LMT)**, Tesla, and NASA.

The true power of Nano Dimension's most recent acquisitions lies not just in owning additional 3D printing technologies, but the potential to integrate them, which will enable entirely new applications and capabilities.

For example, leveraging Nano Dimension's AME tech with Desktop Metal's binder jetting tech to create metal parts and products with embedded electronics.

On its own, Nano Dimension generated about \$58 million in revenue over the past year.

With the addition of Desktop Metal and Markforged, the combined company will generate revenue well north of \$300 million over the next year through the sale of its 3D printers, consumable materials (like proprietary "inks"), software, and services.

So we're talking about inorganic growth of well over 400% this year. I also expect strong organic growth of about 20% next year and 30% the following year.

I must note, however, that when I last spoke to management a few days ago, they stressed that they're prioritizing profitability over the typical growth-at-all-costs approach taken by the industry. That's a good thing. It means the company will likely reach profitability sooner than most folks think is possible. But it also means that the company could shed under-performing businesses, which would impact the top line in the near term.

What's surprising is that Nano Dimension's valuation is smaller today than it was right before the company announced the first of its two most recent acquisitions in early July 2024.

Other than broad weakness in 3D printing stocks, the big reasons for Nano Dimension's severely depressed valuation are a couple of lawsuits involving Desktop Metal and investor disdain for the company's former CEO, Yoav Stern.

Basically, Desktop Metal thought Nano Dimension was trying to drag its feet closing the acquisition so it could get an even better price for the company than \$180 million, or possibly pull out of the agreement entirely. So, Desktop Metal sued Nano Dimension.

With the acquisition now complete, this matter has been put to rest. And it's cleared the path for the completion of the Markforged acquisition within the next couple of weeks.

Regarding how investors felt about Nano Dimension's former CEO, "unhinged" was a term I came across rather frequently in my research. But he's been ousted, and the company named a new CEO, Ofir Baharav, just a few weeks ago on April 8.

Baharav brings decades of leadership experience in additive manufacturing and electronics and has already made big changes, including cost reductions and strategic realignment to put Nano Dimension on a clear path to profitability.

It's not a given that Baharav will be able to successfully integrate Desktop Metal and Markforged into Nano Dimension and realize significant synergies and cost savings in the near term. These kinds of things always involve risk and uncertainty.

But I do expect the company to succeed and reach operating cash flow breakeven within the next four quarters.

Meanwhile, Nano Dimension should have north of \$450 million in cash after it completes the Markforged acquisition. That should be more than enough to fund operations until the company reaches profitability.

Using what would have been the combined company's revenue over the past year, Nano Dimension's current market capitalization, and my forecasted annual organic growth rate of 25%, I calculate a GARP Quotient of 0.04.

That's about as low as it gets... far below the 0.3 threshold that denotes the "extremely promising" tier we talked about in [The Growth Stock Anomaly special report](#).

Action to take: Buy half of a position in Nano Dimension Ltd. (NNDM) at current market prices. Wait for future guidance following the completion of the Markforged acquisition to buy the second half of your position and to set a stop.

America's fastest-growing stocks

In this monthly feature, we share data from our proprietary AI about America's fastest-growing stocks.

In the table below, we share 25 of the fastest-growing stocks in America that fit our *Disruption_X* size criteria. As a reminder, the stocks we're targeting have a market cap between \$200 million and \$20 billion.

Future recommendations may come from this list. It also gives us great insight into what's growing fast and—just as important—what's not. A stock riding on pure hype can't make this list because it requires real, bona fide revenue growth.

Note that these stocks trade on American exchanges. They aren't necessarily American companies.

We also include their raw GARP Quotient based on their most recent quarterly revenue to give an idea of how fairly valued they are.

The GARP Quotient

GARP—or "growth at a reasonable price"—helps us identify rapidly growing stocks that get overlooked by most investors because they *seem* to have unreasonable valuations.

To calculate the [GARP Quotient](#), start with the P/S (price-to-sales) ratio.

Then divide the result of the P/S ratio by the company's revenue growth rate from the last 12 months.

We put potential *Disruption_X* stocks into the following GARP Quotient tiers:

- Above 1.0 = Caution warranted
- Between 0.5 and 1.0 = Good
- Between 0.3 and 0.5 = Great
- Under 0.3 = Extremely promising

Observations this month:

- Revenue is surging across small-cap tech. Five stocks on this list delivered triple-digit revenue growth, despite having market caps under \$1 billion. **Immersion Corp. (IMMR)** and **Hyllion Holdings (HYLN)** show that serious growth is happening well outside the mega-cap names.
- America's advanced hardware renaissance continues. Clean tech, semiconductors, and quantum computing stocks are quietly booming. **Super Micro Computer (SMCI)** and *Disruption_X* holding **Credo Technology Group Holding Ltd. (CRDO)** each logged near or above 100% year-over-year growth, while **Intuitive Machines (LUNR)** reflects growing momentum in aerospace and defense infrastructure.
- Industrial tech is back in fashion. From electric vehicle (EV) insulation to satellite components and chip-level innovation, physical-world disruptors are leading the charge this month. It's a reminder that real-world problems, from energy transmission to manufacturing bottlenecks, are being solved by companies building hardware, not just apps.

A few fast-growing stocks that have our attention:

MediaAlpha (MAX)—Adtech disruptor. MediaAlpha is reinventing how insurance and financial products are marketed through its real-time customer acquisition platform. With 123% revenue growth and a clean 0.36 GARP Quotient, this small cap is quietly turning performance marketing into a precision data science, powering a new wave of digital distribution in a \$1 trillion+ industry.

Aspen Aerogels (ASPN)—EV insulation tech. A behind-the-scenes powerhouse in energy infrastructure, Aspen makes high-performance insulation critical for EV batteries and industrial systems.

Aeva Technologies (AEVA)—Autonomous sensing. Aeva develops LiDAR and perception tech for autonomous systems—think robotics, industrial automation, and next-gen vehicles. With 110% revenue growth, Aeva sits at the intersection of sensing, computing, and physical-world disruption.

This month's list reinforces our conviction that the next great industrial boom in America won't come from reshoring yesterday's factories, but by betting on the bleeding edge of innovation. Software that powers factories, chips that enable automation, and machines that can "print" hardware from scratch... this is the new American manufacturing movement.

Fastest-growing stocks in America							
Rank	Ticker	Name	Description	Mkt cap (million)	Stock Price	Revenue Growth	GARP Quotient
1	IMMR	Immersion Corporation	Haptic software	\$279	\$6.95	3,539%	0.00
2	HYLN	Hyllion Holdings Corp.	Electric truck parts	\$260	\$1.50	316%	13.65
3	EH	EHang Holdings Limited	Chinese Drones	\$803	\$15.55	288%	0.42
4	LUNR	Intuitive Machines, Inc.	Aerospace & defense	\$1,290	\$7.30	187%	3.14
5	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	Computer infrastructure	\$18,047	\$30.82	118%	23.64
6	MAX	MediaAlpha, Inc.	Marketing company	\$534	\$7.92	47%	0.01
7	CLSK	CleanSpark, Inc.	Bitcoin miner	\$2,371	\$8.46	12%	2.83
8	AEVA	Aeva Technologies, Inc.	Lidar sensors	\$343	\$6.27	95%	7.68
9	CRDO	Credo Technology Group	Data infrastructure	\$6,202	\$36.53	99%	11.56
10	HEPS	D-Market Elektronik	Discount retailer	\$977	\$3.14	125%	0.03
11	INOD	Innodata Inc.	AI data services	\$977	\$31.20	123%	0.66
12	IONQ	IonQ, Inc.	Quantum computers	\$5,631	\$25.26	97%	0.12
13	ASPN	Aspen Aerogels, Inc.	Thermal insulation	\$420	\$5.12	85%	3.59
14	BYRN	Byrna Technologies Inc.	Aerospace & defense	\$467	\$20.63	110%	39.29
15	AMTM	Amentum Holdings, Inc.	Defense tech contractor	\$4,630	\$19.12	36%	13.82
16	SOUN	SoundHound AI, Inc.	Voice AI company	\$3,220	\$8.07	96%	14.10
17	VFS	VinFast Auto Ltd.	Vietnamese EV	\$7,260	\$3.11	90%	16.45
18	ATEX	Anterix Inc.	Critical communications	\$577	\$30.99	58%	0.98
19	GCT	GigaCloud Technology Inc.	Wholesale e-commerce	\$506	\$12.64	87%	5.54
20	IDCC	InterDigital, Inc.	Wireless patent licensing	\$4,790	\$186.54	71%	0.00
21	NN	NextNav Inc.	3D geolocation	\$1,461	\$11.06	67%	349.31
22	ZK	ZEEKR Intelligent	Chinese EV	\$4,921	\$19.56	86%	0.42

Fastest-growing stocks in America							
Rank	Ticker	Name	Description	Mkt cap (million)	Stock Price	Revenue Growth	GARP Quotient
23	LCID	Lucid Group, Inc.	American EV	\$7,020	\$2.31	47%	1,962.74
24	SPR	Spirit AeroSystems	Aircraft structures	\$3,978	\$33.92	33%	0.91
25	RIVN	Rivian Automotive, Inc.	American EV	\$12,941	\$11.44	65%	16.84

For the most up-to-date guidance on our current positions, [click here](#) to view the portfolio online.

Chris Wood Stephen McBride

Chris Wood and Stephen McBride

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